

Disability Support & Services

Beyond income, there's real help for daily living, independence, work, and rights — for people with disabilities and their families. Below are the main national starting points. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Free organizations help you live independently, get assistive technology, find work, and protect your rights. Start with a Center for Independent Living — they're run by and for people with disabilities.

1 Independent Living & Daily Support

Local, peer-run help to live independently.

☐ Centers for Independent Living

Free local help with daily living, housing, benefits, and advocacy, run by people with disabilities.

→ www.ilru.org/projects/cil-net/cil-center-and-association-directory

☐ Eldercare/ADRC — Aging & Disability Resource Centers

One-stop local help for long-term services and support.

→ eldercare.acl.gov 1-800-677-1110

2 Care & In-Home Help

Programs that provide and pay for personal support.

☐ Medicaid Home & Community-Based Services

In-home care and support so you can live in your community, not an institution.

→ www.medicaid.gov/medicaid/long-term-services-supports/home-community-based-services/index.html

☐ Get Paid to Care for Family

Medicaid self-directed care may pay a family caregiver. See the Caregivers guide.

→ www.medicaid.gov/medicaid/long-term-services-supports/self-directed-services

3 Work, Tech & Training

Support to work and live more independently.

☐ Vocational Rehabilitation

Free state help to train for, find, and keep a job, including equipment and accommodations.

→ rsa.ed.gov/about/states

☐ Assistive Technology Programs

Each state has a program to help you get devices like wheelchairs and communication tools.

→ www.at3center.net/state-at-programs

☐ Job Accommodation Network (JAN)

Free expert advice on workplace accommodations and disability employment.

→ askjan.org

4 Know & Protect Your Rights

Free help enforcing your rights.

☐ ADA Information Line

Free answers about your rights under the Americans with Disabilities Act.

→ www.ada.gov 1-800-514-0301

☐ Protection & Advocacy (P&A)

Each state has a free legal agency protecting the rights of people with disabilities.

→ www.ndrn.org/about/ndrn-member-agencies

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Be cautious of anyone charging fees for “disability services” that are free through Centers for Independent Living, Vocational Rehabilitation, and your state programs. Assistive-tech programs often lend devices free to try.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Contact your local Center for Independent Living first — they’re free, run by people who understand disability firsthand, and can connect you to nearly everything else in this guide.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national programs. For your local Center for Independent Living and disability services, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
